



In our 90th year of service, the Visakhapatnam Port has embarked on a transformative journey, expanding from 3 berths to over 30. As we transition into a Landlord Mega Port, over 5 PPP Terminals contribute 60% of our throughput, with 3 strategic projects in progress. Our dedication to green initiatives, exemplified by a 10 MW Solar Power Plant and our pursuit of carbon neutrality, establishes us as a pioneer in sustainable port operations. Looking ahead, we envision rapid strides in modernization, mechanization, and decarbonization, shaping a future characterized by efficiency and environmental stewardship

Dr. M. Angamuthu, IAS
Chairman, Visakhapatnam Port Authority

from international sea routes, underscores its pivotal role in global trade networks. Vadhavan Port is destined to be a **hub port in the Arabian Sea**, strategically positioned to cater to the container traffic not only along the east coast of Africa but also along India's west coast and countries in the Persian Gulf.

Another mega port project in the pipeline, the Outer Harbour at V.O. Chidambaranar Port is designed with a **draft provision of 18 meters**, positioning it as a formidable contender in handling large container vessels with a capacity of up to **22,000 TEUs.** With a comprehensive plan that includes the establishment of **two container terminals**, the estimated cost of the project is more than Rs. 7,000 Crores to be developed on Landlord model (PPP). The project is strategically tailored to meet the anticipated traffic demands of the V.O. Chidambaranar Port, with projections suggesting a traffic volume of **4 million TEUs per annum**. This forward-looking vision acknowledges the port's vital role in facilitating trade and commerce, ensuring that it is well-equipped to handle the increasing volume and complexity of maritime activities.

Development of Trans-shipment Hubs in India

India, a key player in global trade, faces a significant challenge as out of the 4.3 million TEUs trans-shipment cargo of Indian Ports, a substantial majority, **around 68%, are transhipped by foreign Ports**. Trans-shipment process refers to transferring containers from one vessel to an intermediary hub before transferring to another vessel for transportation to their final destination. Hubs like **Colombo, Singapore**, and Port Kelang are the key intermediaries for Indian transhipped containers. This poses a significant economic challenge, as it leads to an **annual loss** of **approximately $200-220 million** in potential revenue for Indian ports. The **absence of an Indian Trans-shipment Hub** has been identified as a critical gap in the maritime infrastructure, affecting not only revenue but also presenting a lost opportunity in handling non-India related cargo. The trans-shipment of Indian containers primarily occurred between South Indian ports and foreign hubs, with Kolkata being a notable exception. This geographical skew adversely impacted a considerable segment of India's EXIM (Export-Import) industry concentrated in South India.

To address this pressing issue and to establish India as a prominent player in the trans-shipment landscape, the government is actively working on the development of the **International Container Trans-shipment Port (ICTP)** at **Galathea Bay** in Greater Nicobar Island. This project involves creation of a Mega Trans-shipment Hub with a strategic location on the **East-West International trade route**. With **deep draft** of 20 meters, allowing it to accommodate large vessels, and an impressive overall handling capacity of **16 million TEUs** and overall investment of **more than Rs. 43,000 Crores**, the development of the ICTP is poised to stimulate manufacturing growth and generate employment opportunities. By establishing a Mega Trans-shipment Hub at Galathea Bay, India is positioning itself as a pivotal player in the global container shipping network, enhancing its trade capabilities, and fostering economic development on a national scale.

Another ambitious project, the **Bulk Cargo Transhipment Hub at Atlanta Bay** (North Andaman Island) is strategically designed with a draft of 20 meters, emphasizing its capability to handle large and deep-draft vessels. The proposed Trans-shipment Hub is poised to address the cargo demands of not only **Bangladesh and Myanmar** but also the **Eastern regions of India**. The choice of North Andaman Island for this trans-shipment hub stems from a careful consideration of its **strategic location** as the port's strategic location aligns with the routes of transporting critical materials such as coal, sand, construction materials, iron ore, and more to Bangladesh and Myanmar.

In the wake of these transformative initiatives, India's maritime sector has not only witnessed a remarkable ascent in global competitiveness with a Turnaround Time of 0.9 days where India leads ahead of many maritime nations, underlining its efficiency and operational excellence. The presence of two Indian ports in the Global Top 30 further attests to the nation's maritime prowess. As we chart the course forward, these achievements pave the way for the realization of Hon'ble PM's vision of a 'Vikasit Bharat' through the creation of Deep Draft Mega Ports, establishment of Green Hydrogen Hubs, and the implementation of Smart Ports, as envisioned in the Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047. The future of Indian ports looks promising, and the government's efforts in this regard are likely to pay off in the long run.